



# NINE RULES

## FOR PERSONNEL OF US MILITARY ASSISTANCE COMMAND, VIETNAM

The Vietnamese have paid a heavy price in suffering for their long fight against the communists. We military men are in Vietnam now because their government has asked us to help its soldiers and people in winning their struggle. The Viet Cong will attempt to turn the Vietnamese people against you. You can defeat them at every turn by the strength, understanding, and generosity you display with the people. Here are nine simple rules:

**DISTRIBUTION — 1 to each member of the  
United States Armed Forces in Vietnam**  
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### **Code of conduct**

A card entitled Nine Rules was first issued to US soldiers in Vietnam in 1967. It summarized the US government's view of the reason for the US presence and gave guidelines for the conduct of troops serving in the country.

### **Length of service**

For those who did go, cycling in and out of the war could be a solitary experience. Unlike in World War II, when soldiers served for the duration of the conflict, during the Vietnam War individuals were deployed for a one-year tour of duty. This policy was intended to